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Audience: Software engineering, SRE, data

1. Source control

The default branch is main. Feature work happens on branches named feat/<ticket>-<slug>. Pull requests require one approving review and a green CI pipeline. Direct pushes to main are blocked.

2. Python

Services use Python 3.13, uv for lockfiles, and Ruff for linting. Public functions must have type hints. FastAPI is the standard HTTP framework.

3. Observability

Every inference call must emit an OpenTelemetry span. Traces are exported to Arize Phoenix. Service logs use structured JSON. RED metrics (rate, errors, duration) are required for user-facing APIs.

4. Incident response

Sev-1: customer-facing outage or data loss. Page the on-call engineer and open an incident channel named inc-YYYYMMDD-shortname. A written postmortem is due within 3 business days. Sev-2: degraded performance. Respond within 30 minutes during business hours.

5. Secrets

Secrets live in the platform vault. They must never be committed to git. Rotate leaked credentials within 1 hour.

6. Retrieval systems

Production RAG services store embeddings in PostgreSQL with pgvector. Embedding dimension must match the configured model. Hybrid search (vector + keyword) is required for policy corpora.

7. On-call

Primary on-call rotates weekly. Handoff is Friday 16:00 UTC. The on-call engineer must have laptop access and the production runbook at <https://runbooks.aethercorp.example>.